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| <b>Contact Information</b> | manaswini.rao@gmail.com, manasrao@udel.edu<br>http://manaswinirao.com<br><b>FIELDS:</b> Development Economics, Law and Econ, Political Economy (Organization and Institutional Economics), Agriculture and Natural Resource Economics                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Academic Employment</b> | University of Delaware, Assistant Professor (Tenure Track), Dept. of Economics 08/2023 -<br>UC San Diego, Postdoctoral Scholar, Dept. of Economics 07/2020 - 06/2023                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Affiliations</b>        | The Weiss Fund Junior Faculty Nominee Feb 2026 -<br>Affiliated Faculty, GAP Initiative, Northeastern University July 2024 -<br>Affiliated Faculty, Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL) May 2024 -<br>Affiliated Faculty, UC San Diego 21st Century India Center July 2023 -<br>Invited Researcher, J-PAL South Asia Dec 2021 - May 2024<br>Invited Researcher, The World Bank DIME Group March 2022 - Aug 2023                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Prior Education</b>     | Ph.D., Agricultural and Resource Economics, UC Berkeley 2020<br>Master of Public Policy, UC Berkeley 2010<br>B.Engineering (Comp. Sc.), Visveswaraya Technological Univ, India 2004                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Publications</b>        | “Got (Clean) Milk?: Organization, Incentives, and Management in Indian Dairy Cooperatives” with Ashish Shenoy <i>Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization</i> , Vol 212, Aug 2023, Pages 708-722 ( <a href="#">Open Access Version</a> ) AEA RCT Registry ( <a href="#">#AEARCTR-0000700</a> )<br>Coverage: <a href="#">VoxDev</a><br><br>“Seeding the Seeds: Role of Social Structure in Agricultural Technology Diffusion” with Alain de Janvry and Elisabeth Sadoulet <i>Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization</i> , Vol 236, Aug 2025, 107088, ISSN 0167-2681 AEA RCT Registry ( <a href="#">#AEARCTR-0002157</a> )<br>Coverage: <a href="#">VoxDev</a> , <a href="#">Ideas for India</a> |
| <b>Book Chapters</b>       | Rao, M., Court Efficiency and Business Outcomes: Measuring the Performance of District Courts, in <i>Justice Frustrated: The Systemic Impact of Delays in Indian Courts</i> , Bloomsbury India, Shruti Vidyasagar, Shruthi Naik, and Harish Narasappa (eds) (2020)<br><br>de Janvry, A., Rao, M., Sadoulet, E. (2017) Learning for adopting: Technology adoption in developing country agriculture, Ferdi, 120 p., de Janvry, A., Macours K., Sadoulet, E. (eds) (2017)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Working Papers</b>      | “Front-line Courts as State Capacity: Evidence from India” ( <i>Submitted</i> )<br>Coverage: ( <a href="#">Ideas for India Blog-post</a> , <a href="#">LiveMint</a> , <a href="#">VoxDev</a> , <a href="#">The Policy Edge</a> , <a href="#">The Business Talk with Deepak Bhatt</a> ).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

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| <b>Working Papers</b>     | “Towns and Rural Land Inequality in India” with Prashant Bharadwaj and Juan Eberhard<br>(Submitted)                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                               |
|                           | “The Enforcement Bottleneck: Judicial Capacity and the Limits of Bankruptcy Reform”<br>(Submitted)                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                               |
|                           | “Towards win-win: Evidence from commercial dispute resolution in India” w/ Umer Sohail, Sandhya Seetharaman, and Raghav Pandey                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                               |
|                           | “Whither Justice?: Judicial Capacity Constraints Worsens Trial and Litigants’ Outcomes”                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                               |
|                           | “Land inequality and occupational sorting in India” w/ Harrison Mitchell and Frances Lu                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                               |
|                           | “The Value of Decentralized Decision-Making: Lessons from an Agricultural Infrastructure Experiment” with Xavier Gine, Aprajit Mahajan, Anup Malani <i>Pre-analysis plan filed with the AEA RCT Registry</i> ( <a href="#">#AEARCTR-0004336</a> ). |                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Ongoing Projects</b>   | “Mission Kakatiya: An At-Scale Evaluation of Rehabilitating Irrigation Infrastructure in India” with Xavier Gine, Aprajit Mahajan, Anup Malani <i>Pre-analysis plan filed with the AEA RCT Registry</i> ( <a href="#">#AEARCTR-0001821</a> ).      |                                                                                                                               |
|                           | “Debt Recovery, Information Provision, and Legal Counseling: Experimental Evidence from Mumbai Courts” with Raghav Pandey <i>Full RCT ongoing</i>                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                               |
|                           | “Mastitis treatment in Karnataka: Results from a qualitative scoping survey” with Arpita Hiremath, Vivian Hoffmann, and Ashish Shenoy <i>Qualitative study Coverage: <a href="#">CGIAR Report</a></i>                                              |                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Teaching</b>           | Intermediate Microeconomic Theory (with Calculus)<br>Graduate Development Economics (PhD Field Course)                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Advising (*Member)</b> | Nora Kenaway*, Umer Sohail*, Ryan Gilligan (undergrad RA)                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Grants as PI</b>       | 2025                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | IPA CPRI Grant \$ 75,000 (w/ Raghav Pandey)                                                                                   |
|                           | 2024                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | J-PAL Governance Initiative Multidisciplinary Grant \$ 29,978 (w/ Raghav Pandey); University of Delaware Lerner Grant \$ 4250 |
|                           | 2023                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Center for Effective Governance of Indian States \$ 30,000 (by Karthik Muralidharan)                                          |
|                           | 2022                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | STEG PhD Research Grant £15,000 (w/ Frances Lu and Harrison Mitchell)                                                         |

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| <b>Grants as co-PI</b> | $\leq 2022$ | J-PAL GI and K-CAI Grants \$100,000 and \$101,654; FID Grant €129,720 (w/ Xavier Gine, Aprajit Mahajan, Anup Malani), The World Bank Research Grant \$124,490; ATAI Top-up Grant \$49,207 (w/ Xavier Gine, Aprajit Mahajan, Anup Malani); The World Bank Proposal Development Grant (w/ Xavier Gine, Aprajit Mahajan, Anup Malani, \$30,000) ATAI Grant (w/ Xavier Gine, Aprajit Mahajan, Anup Malani, \$233,565); IGC Grant for Judicial Efficiency and Economic Outcomes (PI Advisor: Aprajit Mahajan, £50,000); The Jean O. Lanjouw Memorial Endowment (\$757); IRLE Graduate Student Award (w/ Vaishnavi Surendra, \$6000); Levin Family Fellowship (w/ Fiona Burlig and Louis Preonas, \$ 800); Maharaj Kaul Research Travel Grant (\$ 1000); Post Primary Education Initiative Exploratory Grant (w/ Bastien Michel and Bhavya Srinivasan, \$ 10,000); USAID DIV Pilot Award, (w/ Emily Breza, Arun Chandrasekhar, and Ashish Shenoy, \$ 99,632) |
| <b>Academic Talks</b>  | 2026        | UC San Diego Development Economics Seminar, UC Irvine Econ Seminar (Theory, History, and Development), IPA GPRL Annual Researcher Gathering, CASI Political Econ Workshop (UPenn)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|                        | 2025        | XI Economic Inequality Conference, Fordham University Economics Seminar, University of Delaware Economics Seminar, PEDL Early Career Researcher Workshop (Yale U), NEUDC (Tufts)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|                        | 2024        | Econometric Society Asia Winter Meetings IIT-Delhi, IGIDR-Mumbai Seminar, William & Mary Economics Seminar, University of Delaware Economics Seminar, The World Bank Land Conference, AEA CSWEP CeMENT Workshop; NEUDC (Northeastern U), Yale YRISE Annual Conference, IFPRI AMD Seminar                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|                        | 2023        | University of Delaware Economics; University of Wisconsin AAE; Ohio State University AEDE; Ashoka University Economics; IIM-Bangalore Econ Area; Shiv Nadar University Economics; Krea University; Firms, Trade, and Development Conference (Yale ECG and the IGC); Yale YRISE Annual Conference                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|                        | 2022        | CGIAR SPIA Webinar; STEG Annual Conference; PacDev (USF); Oxford CSAE Poster Session; Urban Economics Asso. Europe Meeting (LSE); University of Kent (Econ Seminar); Advances in Micro Development Economics-Barcelona GSE Summer Forum; The World Bank ABCDE; NEUDC (Yale); Plaksha University; NYU-Abu Dhabi Economics; IIT-Kanpur Economics                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|                        | 2021        | ASSA Poster Session; PacDev (UC San Diego); Oxford CSAE Conference; University of Kent (Econ Seminar); NBER Org Econ Spring Meet (co-author presenting); UC Riverside (Applied Econ Seminar); NEUDC (Boston U); ISI-Delhi Conference                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|                        | $\leq 2020$ | PacDev (UC Berkeley); SIOE (self organized session); UC San Diego (guest lecture); Advances in Micro Development Economics-Barcelona GSE; Webinar Series in Finance and Development; Virtual Law and Macro Conference (Yale); NBER Fall Development (lightning round), NEUDC 2019 (Northwestern U); J-PAL South Asia Annual Staff Meet 2017; Dept. of Agriculture, Government of Tamil Nadu 2014; PHFI New Delhi 2013                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

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| <b>Refereeing</b>           | <i>American Economic Review; American Economic Review-Insights; Economic Development and Cultural Change; Economics of Education Review; Economic Modelling; Environment and Development Economics; International Review of Finance; Journal of Development Economics; Journal of European Economic Association; Journal of Law and Economics; Journal of Political Economy; Journal of Political Economy: Micro; Journal of Public Economics; Rand Journal of Economics; Review of World Economics; Sustainable Futures; The Review of Economics and Statistics; The Review of Economic Studies; The Economic Journal; The Indian Economic Journal</i> |
| <b>Grant Review Service</b> | <i>Berkeley Economists for Equity; National Science Foundation; J-PAL RFP Grants</i><br><br><i>University of Delaware Economics Seminar Organizer; University of Delaware Faculty Recruitment Committee Member; UCSD-Indian Economy Seminar Series Co-Organizer; AMIE Mentor 2023-24; NEUDC (reviewer), PACDEV (reviewer), Academic Mentor UC Berkeley UN-SDG Undergraduate Research Group Fall 2020; CEGA East Africa Social Science Translation Mentorship Program Spring 2019; Women in Economics (UC Berkeley); UC Berkeley ARE PhD Admissions Committee Student Member; UC Berkeley ARE Department Coffee Hour</i>                                 |
| <b>Prior Employment</b>     | The World Bank, Consultant; J-PAL South Asia, Senior Research Manager (position at the time of exit); The Asian Development Bank, Consultant; Janaagraha, Associate; Infosys Ltd, Software Engineer                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Languages</b>            | English (proficient), Hindi (proficient), Kannada (native), Tamil (conversational), R (proficient), Stata (proficient), Python (Intermediate)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Citizenship</b>          | Indian Citizen (on US H1B)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |